

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting in 3/4 time, featuring treble and bass staves. The key signature has two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with three staves (treble, vocal, and bass). Roman numerals (I, ii, V, I, IV, V^{sus}, III, iii) are placed above the staves to indicate harmonic structure. The lyrics are written below the vocal staff, with line numbers 1, 2, and 3 indicating different parts of the text.

System 1: I ii V I
1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

System 2: I IV V^{sus} V I
hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

System 3: IV ii III
it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

System 4: I iii ii V I
wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.